

REVERSAL

Authority does not come from always being right, it comes from exposing the criterion when you change.

How to reverse a decision without losing authority.

AND THE CONSEQUENCE

A reversal with no visible reasoning is flip flopping.

THE CASCADE

The decision left standing out of pride.

WHAT YOU SEE

You realize early that the decision does not hold up.

THE MECHANISM

Going back looks like admitting weakness, so you wait a little longer.

THE CONSEQUENCE

By the time reality forces the change, the cost has tripled.

Postponing the reversal does not protect your authority. It only inflates the bill it pays.

THE FORK

Why are you changing?

WHY ARE YOU CHANGING

01

Changed because the pressure went up?

that is retreat, and the team can tell

02

Changed because someone important complained?

that is politics, and it teaches people to complain

03

Changed because new data appeared?

that is a reversal, and it strengthens you

The question is not whether you changed. It is what made you change.

THE METHOD

The Receipt, four items.



01 THE PRIOR DECISION

stated in full, with no softening and no rewriting of history

02 THE NEW DATA

what appeared afterward, with a date and a source

03 THE CRITERION THAT CHANGED

the rule that holds from here forward

04 THE COST OWNED

what has already been spent, said out loud by you

The fourth item separates leadership from a memo. Almost nobody delivers it.

WHAT TO ASK, IN ORDER

Four questions before you announce the turn.

01 • THE PRIOR
DECISION

Can you repeat the old decision without softening it?

if you have to soften it, you are still defending yourself

02 • THE NEW
DATA

What exactly appeared that is new?

with a date, otherwise it sounds like an excuse

03 • THE
CRITERION THAT
CHANGED

Which rule holds from now on?

the team has to be able to use it alone

04 • THE COST
OWNED

How much did this cost, and who paid?

saying the number buys more credit than any speech

TWO MODELS

Two ways of changing your mind.

THE COMMON MODEL

Flip flopping

Changes without explaining what changed

Rewrites the old decision as misunderstood

Disappears with the cost already spent

The team starts doubting the next one

THE DESIGNED MODEL

Reversal

Shows the data that turned the key

Repeats the old decision in full

States the cost out loud

The team starts trusting the criterion

MISTAKE AND CONSEQUENCE

Three ways to lose credit when going back.

01 Pretending it was always this way.

- whoever was in the room remembers, and their silence is expensive.

02 Blaming the information instead of the criterion.

- information does not decide, criteria decide.

03 Reversing in silence, with no announcement.

- the team finds out in practice and concludes nobody is in charge.

A silent reversal is the most expensive of all, because it looks like chaos instead of a decision.

THE CHAIN

The third reversal test.

01

Count how many times you reversed on the same topic this year.



02

If it is the third, the problem is not the decision.



03

Then what has to change is how you decide, not what you decided.



WHERE LEADERSHIP STEPS IN

Reversing once is maturity. Reversing always is missing criteria at the entrance.

RUN IT THIS WAY NEXT TIME

Three moves on the next turn.



STEP 01

Repeat the old decision in full, in front of everyone.

no adjective, no mitigating context



STEP 02

Show the new data with a date.

if there is no new data, you are retreating, not reversing



STEP 03

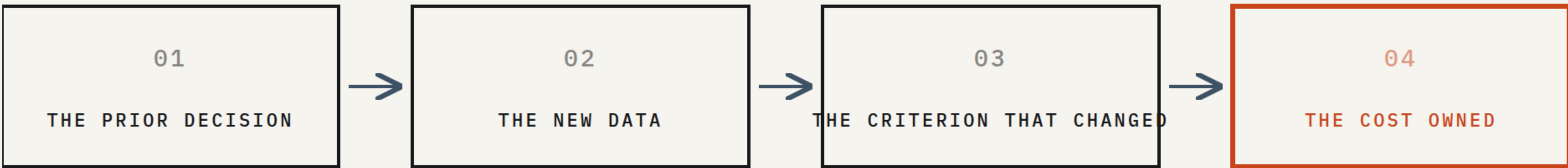
State the cost before anyone asks.

whoever says it first controls the conversation

The conversation lasts five minutes. The credit it creates lasts the whole year.

THE MODEL THAT STICKS

The Receipt, in the order that matters.



Authority does not come from always being right. It comes from showing the criterion.

SAVE THIS FOR LATER

on the next decision you already know has to fall.

FABIO GARCIA

MANAGEMENT AS ENGINEERING
/IN/FALERCIA